

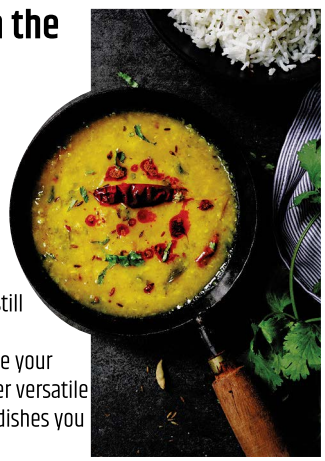
Mastering Indian Flavour with EU Olive Oil



Chef Tips for Authentic Fusion Cooking

March signals the transition to summer and lighter, home-cooked meals across India. As temperatures rise, households naturally adjust ingredients and techniques, moving from richer gravies to fresher dals, sautéed vegetables, and balanced thalis. At the same time, urban home cooks are increasingly open to global ingredients that fit naturally with Indian food habits. Olive oil, once linked primarily to Western cuisine, is steadily becoming part of everyday Indian cooking. With chefs offering practical, culturally rooted guidance, its use is evolving from experimentation to confident application within traditional recipes. **Learn more from More Than Food campaign ambassadors Chef Ajay Chopra and Chef Guntas Sethi.**

Rethinking Olive Oil in the Indian Kitchen



Think about the oils you reach for in your kitchen. A few years ago, olive oil might have been something you reserved for salads or the occasional continental dish. Today, that's changing. Many Indian families are exploring oils that feel lighter while still working across everyday recipes. European olive oil isn't here to replace your traditional cooking, it's simply another versatile option that can fit naturally into the dishes you already make and enjoy.

Chef Guntas Sethi notes, "**It's not about replacing what we've grown up with. It's about choosing ingredients that work well with our techniques.**" From tadka in dals to sautéed bhindi or cabbage sabzi, olive oil is moving from occasional use to a regular kitchen staple. Its balanced flavour can allow you to modernise meals without compromising authenticity.

How EU Olive Oil Performs with Indian Flavours & Techniques

Indian cuisine depends on blooming spices, layered aromatics, and careful heat control. Whether it's cumin crackling in hot oil or garlic turning lightly golden, the cooking medium must enhance not mask flavour. EU olive oil complements staples like mustard seeds, chillies, ginger, and coriander by allowing their aromas to develop cleanly.

Chef Ajay Chopra explains, "When you temper spices, the oil should carry their fragrance, not compete with it. EU olive oil keeps the flavour profile balanced." Suitable for sautéing, light frying, marinades, and tempering, it enhances texture while keeping dishes lighter, ideal for summer cooking. This consistency is one reason chefs rely on it for both traditional and contemporary Indian recipes, it's something you can easily bring into your own kitchen as well.

Chef Tips for Everyday Indian & Fusion Cooking

Chefs emphasise thoughtful usage rather than drastic change. Extra virgin olive oil works well for finishing dishes, dressings, and gentle sautéing. Moderate heat is key, especially for tadkas, to prevent the oil from overheating and to preserve flavour integrity.

Chef Ajay Chopra shares, "In moong dal, rajma, chole, or a simple lauki sabzi, olive oil gives a clean finish. Let the spices bloom slowly and avoid smoking the oil." He recommends adding a light drizzle just before serving to enhance aroma.



Chef Guntas Sethi adds, "EU olive oil is reliable because of its quality standards. It adapts easily – from everyday vegetables to fusion dishes." She suggests using it in marinades for paneer tikka, tossing roasted vegetables with it instead of cream, and balancing spice intensity with the right amount of oil for authentic taste.



Trust & Quality - Understanding EU Olive Oil

EU olive oil is supported by strict quality standards. Certifications such as

PDO (Protected Designation of Origin)

PGI (Protected Geographical Indication)

ensure traceability, authenticity, and consistent production standards. These labels give urban households confidence when selecting olive oil for daily cooking. Examples of EU olive oils include Azeite de Trás-os-Montes, PDO (Portugal), , Terra di Bari PDO (Italy), and Χανιά Κρήτης / Chania Kritis PGI (Greece), each offering distinct flavours suited to various Indian dishes.



Terra di Bari PDO Italy



Χανιά Κρήτης / Chania Kritis PGI Greece



Azeite de Trás-os-Montes, PDO Portugal

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